

7.4 Manual Focus

For expert photographers who want to be able to control the amount of focus and the object to be focussed, the manual focus feature is what matters the most. This is a feature found on every DSLR and some of the high-end point-and-shoot cameras have it too.

Focussing on DSLRs is done by first setting the lens unit or the camera body to manual focus. With that set, the motor is disengaged. You can then rotate the focus ring on the camera till your target gets focussed.

The manual focus feature can't be found in every P&S camera and focussing is also different in this case. There is often no ring to rotate on the focussing lens. To enable this, set the camera to manual mode. Set the rest of the settings such as the ISO, aperture size and shutter speed as you wish. Then, use the focus button if there is one till you switch to manual mode. A small scale or indicator will then be displayed at the bottom of the screen. The distance of the object in focus will be mentioned. Either use the directional keys on the camera or a gradually rotate the jog dial till the target is in focus.

Macro focussing is slightly tricky as the distance to the objects is at its minimum. In P&S cameras, turn on the macro



Manual focus and image stabilisation can be turned on by the flip of a switch

shooting mode before trying to focussing on the target. You will only be able to focus once you get close enough to the object. This depends on the range of your lens. This applies to both DSLRs and P&S cameras.